



भारतीय रिज़र्व बैंक  
RESERVE BANK OF INDIA  
www.rbi.org.in

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July 29, 2021

All deposit taking Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)

Madam/ Dear Sir,

**Rating of Deposits of HFCs – Approved Credit Rating Agencies and Minimum Investment Grade Credit Rating**

A reference is invited to Para 25.2 of [Master Direction – Non-Banking Financial Company – Housing Finance Company \(Reserve Bank\) Directions, 2021](#), wherein the names of five approved credit rating agencies and their minimum investment grade credit rating for the purpose of accepting public deposits have been listed.

2. On a review, it has been decided to align the aforesaid provisions for HFCs with provisions on the subject prescribed for NBFCs which are contained in Para 9 of [Master Direction - Non-Banking Financial Companies Acceptance of Public Deposits \(Reserve Bank\) Directions, 2016](#). Accordingly, the names of credit rating agencies and their minimum investment grade ratings for the purpose of accepting public deposits by HFCs are listed in the [Annex](#).

3. The [Master Direction – Non-Banking Financial Company – Housing Finance Company \(Reserve Bank\) Directions, 2021](#) is being modified accordingly.

Yours faithfully,

(J.P. Sharma)  
Chief General Manager

**List of Credit Rating Agencies and their respective minimum investment grade ratings**

| Sl. No. | Name of the rating agency                                        | Minimum investment grade credit rating |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 1       | The Credit Rating Information Services of India Limited (CRISIL) | FA– (FA Minus)                         |
| 2       | ICRA Limited                                                     | MA– (MA Minus)                         |
| 3       | Credit Analysis & Research Limited (CARE)                        | CARE BBB (FD)                          |
| 4       | Fitch Ratings India Private Limited                              | tA– (ind)(FD)                          |
| 5       | Brickwork Ratings India Private Limited (Brickwork) *            | BWR FBBB                               |
| 6       | Acuite Ratings & Research Limited **                             | ACUITE A                               |
| 7       | Infomerics Valuation and Rating Private Limited (IVRPL) **       | IVR BBB                                |

\* Rating changed from BWR FA to BWR FBBB for deposits of HFCs, to align with NBFCs.

\*\* New credit rating agencies along with ratings for deposits of HFCs, to align with NBFCs.

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Withdrawn